

O.P. SMITH

TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Main thumbnail: NOT RETREATING (made with vidIQ, in the style of Tactical Genius's best performers)

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	OP-Smith-Top3-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, size: see final render)
Length	about 16:09
Voice	Kokoro (free AI voice)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice
Sound effects	Freesound recordings (CC BY / CC0) plus original effects

Structure and chapters

Chapter	Starts	What happens
Intro: trapped at the Chosin Reservoir	0:00	Stakes-first cold open: 15,000 Marines, ~120,000 Chinese, one mountain road, 78 miles from the sea
Move 1: Inchon	1:36	Wolmi-do first, then Red and Blue Beach: the landing over the seawall
Move 2: Hagaru-ri	6:02	The slow advance against Almond's pressure, the Hagaru-ri airstrip, the night defence
Move 3: The breakout	10:48	The column from Hagaru-ri, the Funchilin bridge airdrop, Hungnam
Smith's legacy	15:06	Callback, the three rules, 'which commander next?'

Key frames



2. Title and thumbnail

Title (recommended)

How 15,000 Marines Broke Out of a 120,000-Man Chinese Trap | O.P. Smith's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves

Alternatives to A/B test (YouTube 'Test & compare'):

- O.P. Smith's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves
- The General Who Refused to Be Destroyed: O.P. Smith's 3 Greatest Moves

Why this thumbnail

All the Tactical Genius thumbnails use the same picture (dark aerial battlefield with red/blue unit blocks and white arrows, commander portrait on the right, red brush banner bottom-left). What decides the click is the **text**: the winners are 1-3 words that make sense with zero context and create tension: the hero's defiance (LET THEM COME, 1.0M views), the enemy's contempt as a real quote ("AMATEURS", 773k) or ominous stakes (AT THE GATES, 585k, 24.7x). The losers are nicknames that need background ("DUGOUT DOUG" 29k, "SEPOY GENERAL" 6k) and lines of 4+ words.

Our main thumbnail uses the winning type 1, the hero's defiance: **NOT RETREATING**, from Smith's "We are not retreating..." line (no quote marks because it is shortened). The portrait is a generic 1950 US Marine general (parka, cap, binoculars), not a likeness of a real person.

Alternative thumbnail (use it for YouTube's thumbnail A/B test)



Alternative: SURROUNDED (type 3, ominous stakes) for the A/B test. AI slips: on SURROUNDED the AI misspelled the reservoir label as "CHGSIN"; this was fixed by hand and it now reads CHOSIN RESERVOIR. On NOT RETREATING the red blocks form a thin dotted ridge line rather than many, and some trucks and prop planes appear (era-appropriate). Labels are correct.

Before uploading: check the thumbnail at small size on a phone. The banner text must be readable at 20% size.

3. Description (copy and paste)

Everything below is ready to paste into the YouTube description box (the first line is the title). The credit lines are required by the image, music and sound-effect licences: do not remove them.

How 15,000 Marines Broke Out of a 120,000-Man Chinese Trap | O.P. Smith's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves

November 1950. Fifteen thousand Marines, a hundred and twenty thousand Chinese, thirty degrees below zero. At the Chosin Reservoir.

Which commander should I cover next? Let me know in the comments.

CHAPTERS

0:00 Intro: trapped at the Chosin Reservoir

1:36 Move 1: Inchon

6:02 Move 2: Hagaru-ri

10:48 Move 3: The breakout

15:06 Smith's legacy

SOURCES

Hampton Sides, *On Desperate Ground: The Marines at the Reservoir* (2018)

Martin Russ, *Breakout: The Chosin Reservoir Campaign, Korea 1950* (1999)

Joseph H. Alexander, *Battle of the Barricades: U.S. Marines in the Recapture of Seoul* (Marine Corps Historical Center, 1999)

Roy E. Appleman, *East of Chosin: Entrapment and Breakout in Korea, 1950* (1987)

Lynn Montross & Nicholas Canzona, *U.S. Marine Operations in Korea, Vol. III: The Chosin Reservoir Campaign* (USMC History Center, 2000)

CREDITS

Maps: terrain from Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data).

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish"

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Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots" by Aegersum (CC BY 4.0)

More sound effects (freesound.org): "Strong Blizzard" by ZwelinSounds (CC BY 3.0), "OldMilitaryTrucks" by daveincamas

Archival film: U.S. National Archives (NARA) / U.S. Department of Defense, public domain, via Internet Archive.

Images (via Wikimedia Commons):

- "Change of Command Ceremony, 1951" by USMC Archives from Quantico, USA, CC BY 2.0

- Public domain: U.S. Marine Corps, U.S. Navy, U.S. Army and NARA photographs (O.P. Smith, Edward Almond, MacArthur at Chosin Reservoir)

#KoreanWar #ChosinReservoir #MilitaryHistory #USMC #Inchon

4. Upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags	O.P. Smith, Oliver P. Smith, Chosin Reservoir, Frozen Chosin, Inchon landing, Hagaru-ri, Korean War, US Marines, 1st Marine Division, military history, tactics, battle map, animated battle map, Tactical Genius
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Language / captions	English; let YouTube auto-caption, then check the names (Hagaru-ri, Koto-ri, Yudam-ni, Funchilin, Song Shilun, Almond, Wolmi-do, Chosin)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: the narration is an AI voice and the thumbnail is AI-generated. Tick the disclosure box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first chapter is 0:00)
Pinned comment	Which commander should I cover next? Ridgway, Puller, Nathanael Greene, Daniel Morgan...?
Schedule	Your audience's peak time (check YouTube Studio > Analytics > Audience)

Upload checklist

- Play the 1080p master through once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master (not the 540p preview parts).
- Paste title, description and tags; upload the thumbnail (1280x720).
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'.
- Add end screen and cards; set visibility and schedule.
- After 24-48 h: check click-through rate and 30-second retention in YouTube Studio; if CTR is under 4%, swap to the alternative thumbnail.

Facts to double-check before publishing:

- Chosin casualty figures (check Montross & Canzona, vol. III).
- Almond's helicopter flight.
- The "12 divisions" figure.
- The 27 Nov 1950 front positions on the maps are approximate.